- acquire knowledge of using how to use food additives.
- detect food adulterants in the foods available at home.

6.1 Spices

A spice is a seed, fruit, root, bark or leaf of plant substance primarily used for flavouring, colouring and preserving food. Spices are distinguished from herbs while the herbs are the leaves, flowers or stems from plants used for flavouring or as a garnish. In the culinary arts, the word ***spice means "Any dried part of a plant, or bay leaf which is used as spice and it used for seasoning and flavouring a recipe, but not used as the main ingredient".***

6.1.1 Role of spices in Indian cookery

- Spices add flavour to food, make the food palatable and add variety in the daily diet.
- Spices stimulate salivation, acid secretion and digestive enzymes.
- Spices like turmeric, pepper have medicinal values such as anti-inflammatory, anti-bacterial, stimulant and antioxidant properties.
- Spices help in improving the impaired blood glucose levels in the body and control diabetes.
- Spices reduce cholesterol levels and useful in preventing heart diseases.
- Spices act as preservatives, thus prolongs the shelf life of foods.

ACTIVITY - 1

Does the spice available in your home fulfill the following? Please tick ☑ or ☒

1. Increases food quantity: ☐
2. Adds flavour to food: ☐
3. Gives colour to food: ☐
4. Enrich taste of food: ☐
5. Increase nutrient value: ☐

6.1.2 Nutritional Value of Spices

Spices are usually used in small quantities to flavour a dish. They add few calories to meal and cause a less impact on the nutritive value of foods. Spices add calories to food in negligible amount, even though many spices made from seeds contain high portions of fat, protein and carbohydrate when used in larger quantities.

DO YOU KNOW...?

Food Fact: India is the major producer, consumer and exporter, of spices in the world. India produces about 60 lakh MT of spices which 6.9 lakh MT(11%) is been exported to 150 countries. (*Source: Ministry of Spice Board of India)MT-Metric tone

DO YOU KNOW...?

India is said to be the home of Spices. World most expensive spice is saffron and second most expensive spice is cardamom. (*Source: Indian Spice Board. Com). In India Kerala produces 95% of total pepper output.

UNIT-06_090-107.indd 91 22-01-2020 14:31:28